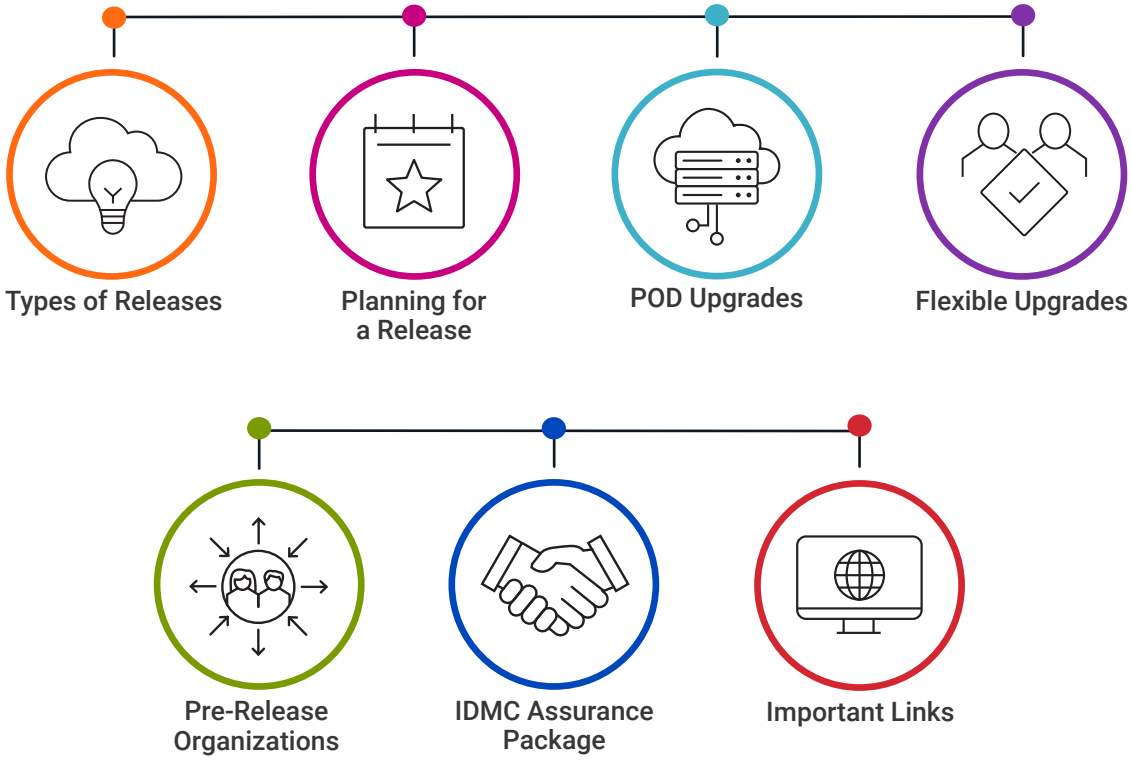
Informatica
from Salesforce

Intelligent Data Management Cloud
Release Readiness

This document provides an overview of the Informatica® Intelligent Data Management Cloud™ (IDMC) releases and the release process. It explains the different types of releases, how to prepare for a release, and where to find functionality and upgrade information. It also explains the pre-release process and how to participate in the pre-release.



Where data & AI come to LIFE

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Types of Releases

Informatica typically releases multiple versions of IDMC each year. A release can be a patch, standard, or major release.

The following table summarizes the changes in each release type:

Change	Patch	Standard	Major
Secure Agent upgrade			✓
Critical security fixes that cause UI downtime			✓
New features that do not cause UI downtime		✓	✓
Security fixes, bug fixes, and EBFs	✓	✓	✓
Changes that impact FedRAMP compliance or certification			✓
Flexible upgrades		✓	✓

A pre-release period occurs at least one day before a patch or standard release and at least three weeks before a major release.

> **Note:** Informatica may, at its discretion, modify the scope of, change the schedule for, or cancel a release, if required.

Patch Releases

Patch releases can include the following changes:

- Security fixes
- Bug fixes
- Emergency bug fixes (EBFs) that are found by Informatica or by customers

Patch releases typically don't include new features, behavior changes, new agent packages, Secure Agent upgrades, behavior changes that cause the UI to become unavailable during deployment, or changes that impact FedRAMP compliance or certification. If a patch release includes any of these changes, they're noted on Pulse.

Deployment window

The deployment window for a patch release is typically four hours. The user interface (UI) remains up and running during the deployment, with no impact to scheduled or running tasks and processes.

The following services are deployed to customer PODs (Points of Deployment) in the last week of the release month:

- Data Governance and Catalog
- Data Marketplace
- Metadata Command Center

To find the deployment schedule for your organization and POD, see Pulse.

Standard Releases

Standard releases can include the following changes:

- New features, functionality, and behavior changes that don't cause the UI to become unavailable
- Security fixes
- Bug fixes
- Emergency bug fixes (EBFs) that are found by Informatica or by customers

Standard releases typically don't include new agent packages, Secure Agent upgrades, behavior changes that cause the UI to become unavailable during deployment, or changes that impact FedRAMP compliance or certification. If a standard release includes any of these changes, they're noted in Pulse.

Deployment window

The deployment window for a standard release is typically four hours. During the deployment window, IDMC remains up and running with the following impacts to services and functionality:

Data Ingestion and Replication
Runtime continuity isn't available for initial load jobs. Before the deployment window, stop any running initial load jobs and disable scheduled initial load jobs. After deployment, restart the jobs from the beginning. Runtime continuity is available for incremental load and combined initial and incremental load jobs. These jobs are briefly on hold during deployment and automatically resume processing after deployment.

Deployment for flexible upgrade services

You can upgrade the following services in your organization during a designated window:

- Address Verification API
- Data Governance and Catalog
- Data Marketplace
- Metadata Command Center

For these services, deployment to your POD occurs during the last week of the release month. After deployment, you can schedule your organization's upgrade for any date and time during the flexible upgrade window. You can reschedule the upgrade as needed during this window.

After the flexible upgrade window ends, the Informatica Cloud Operations team automatically upgrades any organizations that customers didn't upgrade.

To find the deployment schedule for your organization and POD, see Pulse.

Major Releases

Major releases can include the following changes:

- New features and functionality
- Behavior changes
- New agent packages
- Secure Agent upgrades
- Security fixes
- Bug fixes
- Emergency bug fixes (EBFs) that are found by Informatica or by customers
- Changes that impact FedRAMP compliance or certification

Before a major release, Informatica recommends that you participate in the pre-release to understand the impact of changed behavior on your critical assets and to test these assets.

Secure Agents

Two or three days before deployment, Informatica upgrades IDMC services and downloads the new Secure Agent upgrade package and connectors to each agent server. To accommodate two versions of the agent running simultaneously, make sure that your Secure Agent machines have a minimum of 10 GB free disk space.

To verify that the Secure Agent upgraded successfully and your jobs use the latest agent version, go to the **Runtime Environments** page in Administrator to confirm that the **Upgrade Status** is **Up-to-date**.

Deployment window

The deployment window for a major release is typically 3.5 hours. During the deployment window, IDMC services and functionality are impacted as follows:

Administrator

The following Administrator pages remain available:

- Organization
- Ecosystem SSO
- Licenses
- SAML Setup
- Metering, except for the ability to download detailed service reports
- Settings
- Users
- User Groups
- User Roles

You can also set permissions for runtime environments or schedules, and you can view dependencies for runtime environments. In some cases, details and clickable links for the dependencies aren't available.

Monitor
The following Monitor pages remain available:

- All Jobs
- Import/Export Logs
- Running Jobs
- Source Control Logs

You can't drill down on job or asset details during the deployment window.

Data Ingestion and Replication
Runtime continuity isn't available for initial load jobs. Before the deployment window, stop any running initial load jobs and disable scheduled initial load jobs. After deployment, restart the jobs from the beginning. Runtime continuity is available for incremental load and combined initial and incremental load jobs. These jobs are briefly on hold during deployment and automatically resume processing after deployment.

Other services
For services that have runtime continuity, there is no impact to scheduled or running tasks and processes.

For services that don't have runtime continuity, you'll need to restart your tasks after deployment. Long-running tasks that begin before the deployment window continue running for up to 24 hours after the deployment window. If the tasks run longer, you'll need to restart them within those 24 hours.

For more information, see Runtime continuity for POD upgrades.

REST API
Informatica advises against development activities that use the IDMC REST API, such as creating or updating tasks.

To find the deployment schedule for your organization and POD, see Pulse.

Deployment for flexible upgrade services

You can upgrade the following services in your organization during a designated window:

- Data Governance and Catalog
- Data Marketplace
- Metadata Command Center

For these services, deployment to your POD occurs during the last week of the release month. After deployment, you can schedule your organization's upgrade for any date and time during the flexible upgrade window. You can reschedule the upgrade as needed during this window.

After the flexible upgrade window ends, the Informatica Cloud Operations team automatically upgrades organizations that customers didn't upgrade.

Pre-Release

You can test upcoming features, functionality, behavior changes, and bug fixes in certain services during
the pre-release period, which occurs at least one day before a patch or standard release and at least three weeks before a major release.

For a list of services that participate in pre-releases, see the **Pre-Release** column on the **POD Availability and Networking** page.

The following services are not available for pre-release testing:

- CLAIRE GPT
- Data Governance and Catalog
- Data Marketplace
- Metadata Command Center

For upgrading these services, see **Flexible Upgrades**.

How to participate in the pre-release

You can participate in the pre-release if you purchased the IDMC Assurance Package or your organization has usage-based licenses, which enable billing through Informatica Processing Units (IPUs). For MDM SaaS, you must purchase the MDM SaaS pre-release organization offering. To participate, you need to create a new organization on the pre-release POD for testing purposes only.

Pre-release documentation

During the pre-release period before a major release, Informatica updates the online help to reflect the pre-release functionality. The **documentation portal** continues to provide information about the current release only.

Informatica updates the help and **documentation portal** content when a major release starts.

Planning for a Release

How you plan for a release depends on the release type.

Patch Release Planning

To plan for a patch release, perform the following tasks:

1. Check Pulse to find out when the release starts. Information will be available on Pulse at least one week before the upgrade starts.
2. Verify the deployment date and time for your POD. You can't change the deployment date or time.

   Tip: You can subscribe to updates to get information about your POD. Notifications are sent through Pulse one week before the upgrade starts.
3. Review the release notes for the services you use to learn about known and fixed issues. For patch releases, the release notes are available in the online help and on the documentation portal the day before the release starts.

Standard Release Planning

To plan for a standard release, perform the following tasks:

1. Check Pulse to find out when the release starts. Information is available on Pulse at least one week before the upgrade starts.
2. Verify the deployment date and time for your POD. You can't change the deployment date or time.

   Tip: You can subscribe to updates to get information about your POD. Notifications are sent through Pulse one week before the upgrade starts.
3. Review What's New in IDMC to make sure you understand the new features, changed behaviors, and upgrade tasks that you might need to perform. For standard releases, What's New in IDMC is available one day before the release starts.
4. Review the release notes for the services you use to learn about known and fixed issues. For standard releases, the release notes are available in the online help and on the documentation portal the day before the release starts.

Major Release Planning

If you've selected to receive Critical Event alerts, Informatica Global Customer Support will notify you of an upcoming major release two weeks before the release starts. The release date is also posted on Pulse.

To plan for a major release, perform the following tasks:

1. Verify the deployment date and time for your POD on Pulse. You can't change the deployment date or time.

   Tip: You can subscribe to updates to get information about your POD. Notifications are sent through Pulse one week before the upgrade starts.
2. Review What's New in IDMC to make sure you understand the new features, changed behaviors, and upgrade tasks that you might need to perform. For major releases, What's New in IDMC is available during the pre-release period (three weeks before the release starts).
3. Review the release notes for the services you use to learn about known and fixed issues. For major releases, the release notes are available in the online help three weeks before the release starts and on the documentation portal the day before the release starts.
4. In the three weeks before the release starts, register for the pre-release and create a pre-release organization, if you haven't already done this.
5. Export some critical assets to your pre-release organization, update the targets, and verify the results.
6. Three days before the release, verify that you have enough disk space and available memory to accommodate two Secure Agent versions running in parallel during the deployment window. The amount of disk space required is documented in the *Upgrade* section of What's New in IDMC.
7. Perform any applicable post-upgrade tasks described in the *Upgrade* section of What's New in IDMC.

POD Upgrades

PODs are upgraded on a rolling basis starting the first day of a release. The deployment schedule varies by POD.

> **Tip:** To find your POD, log in to IDMC and view the POD name in the browser URL. If you aren't sure of your organization ID, see **Organization settings**.

Pulse lists the deployment schedule for all PODs. The deployment window is typically three or four hours based on the release type. If your organization has different environment types, such as QA and production, upgrades might be deployed to the environment types on different dates.

You can't export or import assets from upgraded PODs to PODs that haven't been upgraded. If you have multiple organizations on different PODs, Informatica recommends that you avoid exporting and importing assets between organizations until all PODs are updated.

During the deployment window for a major release, some services might be unavailable. Services that have runtime continuity continue to be available during the deployment window.

Runtime Continuity for POD Upgrades

Some services have runtime continuity during major releases. Runtime continuity enables you to continue to use the service during the deployment window.

If a service has runtime continuity, you don't have to stop running jobs, disable scheduled jobs, or set a blackout period during an upgrade. You can continue to run processes, run jobs that use externalized connections, and accept API calls.

You can also continue to submit jobs through external schedulers, the IDMC REST API, and the RunAJob utility. These jobs will continue to run successfully during the deployment window.

The following services and features have runtime continuity:

- Advanced Serverless
- API Center
- Application Integration
- Data Integration, including Advanced
- Data Profiling, including Advanced
- Data Quality, including Advanced
- File Ingestion and Replication
- Human Task Workflow
- INFACore
- Integration Hub (hosted publication repository)
- MDM SaaS
- Streaming Ingestion and Replication

Any exceptions to runtime continuity will be communicated in **Pulse**.

If your service or feature doesn't have runtime continuity, stop running jobs and disable scheduled jobs before the deployment window. If possible, set a blackout period. When deployment begins, pause active development.

For more information about the Streaming Ingestion POD upgrade, see **Frequently asked questions for Streaming Ingestion and Replication behavior**.

Runtime Continuity for Application Integration

Runtime continuity for Application Integration ensures that connectivity between cloud and on-premises systems isn't interrupted during upgrade.

During the deployment window for a major release, Process Server appears as "*Restart Required*" when your organization upgrades to the new release.

Process recovery takes place when Process Server restarts, and it happens automatically if the agent is running standalone or in a load-balanced configuration. If the agent is running in a clustered configuration, process instances automatically fail over to another node when one node is restarted.

For more information about load balancing and clustering, see the following Knowledge Base article: **Cloud Application Integration - Process Server Load Balancing and Clustering on Secure Agent**.

Runtime Continuity for Data Ingestion and Replication

For Data Ingestion and Replication, runtime continuity is not available for initial load jobs. Before the deployment window, stop any running initial load jobs and disable scheduled initial load jobs. After deployment, restart the jobs from the beginning.

Runtime continuity is available for incremental load and combined initial and incremental load jobs. These jobs are briefly on hold during deployment and automatically resume processing after deployment.

Subscribing to POD Upgrade Alerts

To get notifications about maintenance, incidents, and releases, subscribe to alerts in **Pulse**.

1. In **Pulse**, open the **Subscriptions** page.
2. Click **New** to create a subscription.



3. Select a POD.
4. Select a communication channel, such as email or webhook.

5. Click the box next to **My Services** to select all services or select individual services. Then subscribe to incidents, releases, or both.
6. Click **Save**.



7. Check your inbox for an email from Informatica asking you to confirm your subscription. When you confirm your subscription, you'll be redirected to Pulse with a message that your subscription settings were updated.

To change your subscription settings, return to the **Subscriptions** page and edit the subscription. To unsubscribe from Pulse notifications, select the subscription and select **Delete**.

For more information, see Service Status and Communications.

Flexible Upgrades

Some IDMC services can manually upgrade their organization during a designated period called a *flexible upgrade window*.

Informatica deploys a release to your POD on the dates listed in Pulse and then assigns an upgrade date for your organization. The flexible upgrade window is a specific period that extends a few weeks before or after this upgrade date.

You can schedule an upgrade for any date and time during the flexible upgrade window, and you can reshedule as needed. For example, you can upgrade development, UAT, and production environments at different times.

The following services can upgrade their organizations during the flexible upgrade window:

- Data Governance and Catalog
- Data Marketplace
- Metadata Command Center

You can perform upgrade tasks if you're an organization administrator or you have the *Manage Upgrade* privilege in Administrator.

During an organization upgrade, jobs in progress continue running. However, the catalog is read-only, and users can't start new jobs or create, edit, or delete business assets.

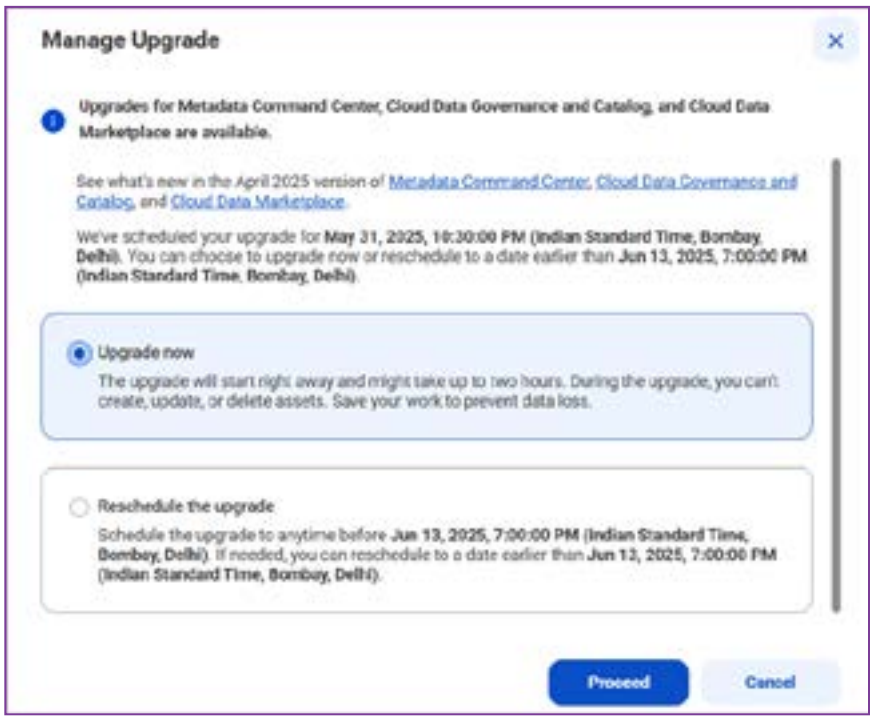
Upgrade Notifications

At each stage of the upgrade process, email and user interface notifications indicate the upgrade status.

When an upgrade is available, the following notification banner appears in Metadata Command Center with links to view the flexible upgrade window, open the *What's New* help, and define the upgrade schedule.

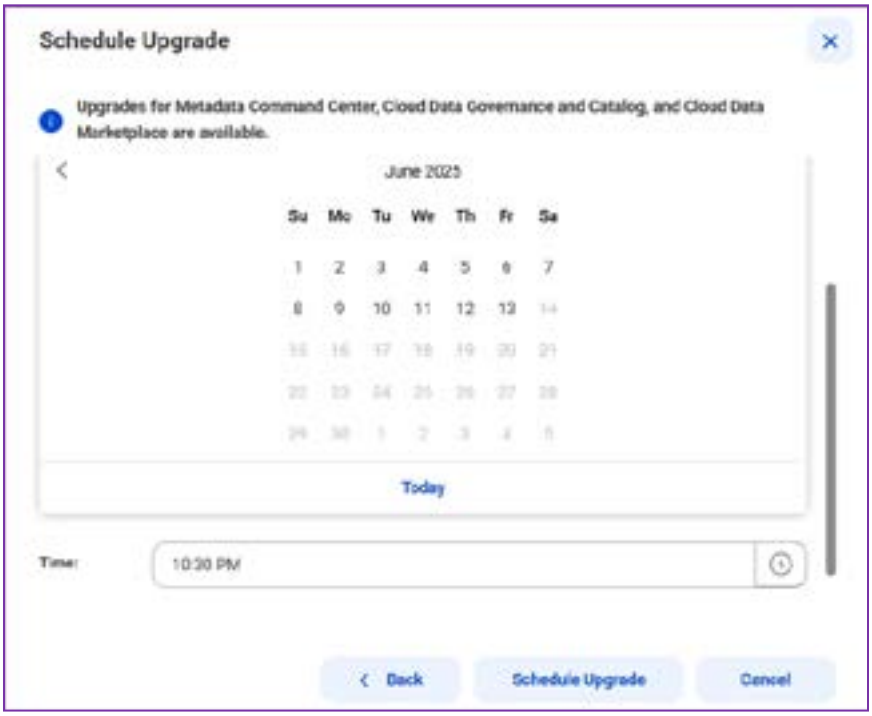


When you click **Manage Upgrade**, the following dialog box appears:

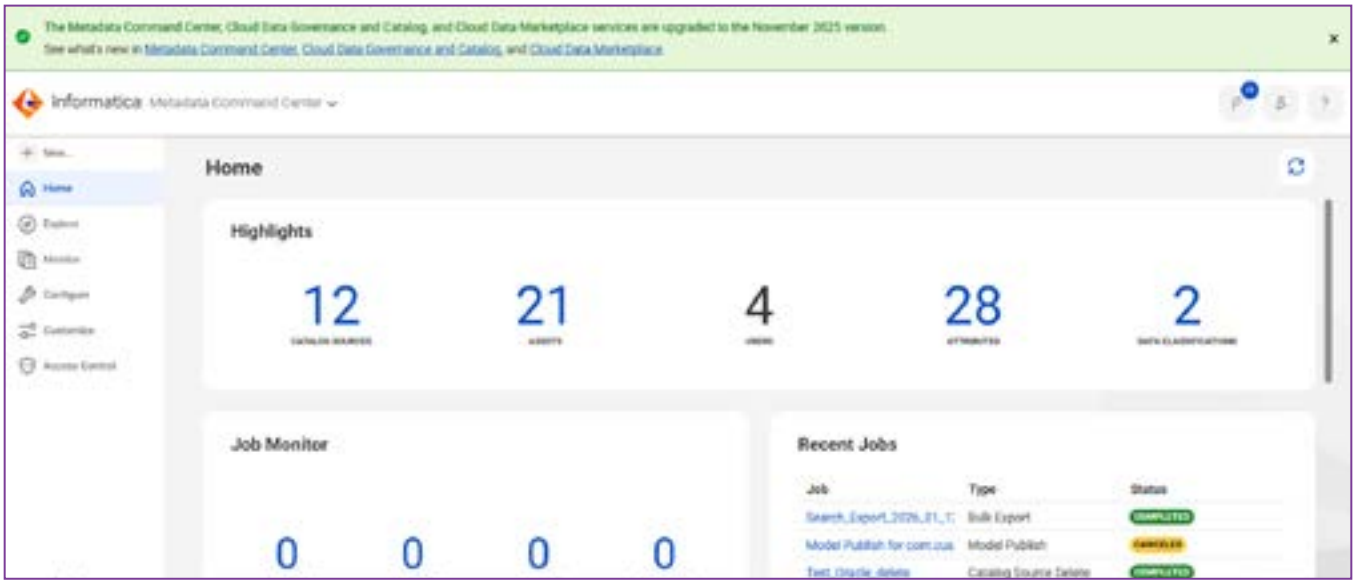


You can upgrade the organizations immediately, schedule the upgrade for another day during the flexible upgrade window, and reschedule the upgrade as needed during this window.

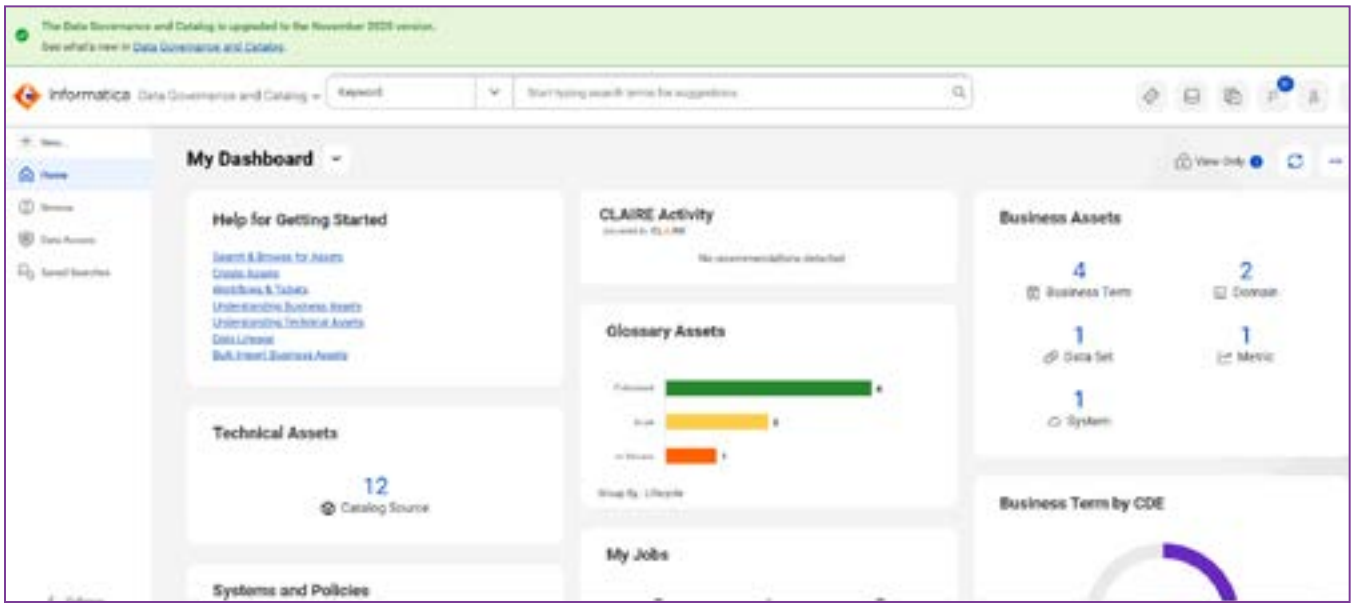
The following image shows the available window for upgrading an organization:



Fifteen minutes before the upgrade starts, a notification appears. After the upgrade is complete, administrators will see the following notification banner in Metadata Command Center.



After the upgrade is complete, non-administrator users will see the following notification banner in Data Governance and Catalog.



Pre-Release Organizations

Before a major release, Informatica recommends that you participate in the pre-release to understand and test the impact of changed behavior on your critical assets.

To participate, you need to create an organization on the pre-release POD hosted on AWS in North America or Europe. If you have an organization that you used during a pre-release, you can use the same organization for the pre-releases of other services.

For major releases, the pre-release POD is updated with the new release three weeks before the upgrade. For standard and patch releases, the pre-release POD is updated one day before the upgrade.

When you create a pre-release organization, you'll need to create new users, user groups, and Secure Agents in the organization. You can create new assets, or you can export mappings and tasks from your production organizations to your pre-release organization. After you create or import assets in your pre-release organization, the assets remain there and do not expire.

Tasks and processes

You run tasks and processes in your pre-release organization just as you do in a production organization. Running tasks and processes consumes IPUs, the same as a production organization.

Test data

All customers must use test data in pre-release organizations. Non-US customers are required to comply with all applicable data privacy, security, and transport laws in their respective jurisdictions when transferring or using data in a US pre-release POD.

For MDM SaaS, you can load a maximum of 25,000 source records.

Data encryption

In pre-release organizations, data is encrypted using Informatica-managed keys. You can't use customer-managed keys.

Private connectivity

Pre-release organizations don't support private connectivity between your VPC or Azure account and IDMC. Therefore, you can't configure a private connection with IDMC using AWS PrivateLink or Azure Private Link for a pre-release organization.

Creating a Pre-Release Organization

You only need to create a pre-release organization once. You can continue to use the same pre-release organization for testing during subsequent releases.

1. Allow the pre-release environment IP addresses on the organization firewall. For the list of IP addresses, see **POD Availability and Networking**.
2. Open a Product Download & License Request with Informatica Global Customer Support saying that you want to create a pre-release organization. Include your production organization ID in the request.
3. Informatica Global Customer Support will create a pre-release organization for you that has the same licenses as your production organization, and they'll notify you when it's ready to use. The pre-release organization type will be listed as an additional production or sandbox organization.
4. Log in to your organization on the pre-release POD using one of the following URLs:
   - North America: **https://dmr-us.informaticacloud.com**
   - Europe: **https://dmr-em.informaticacloud.com**
5. Download and install a Secure Agent. For instructions, see **Secure Agent installation in a cloud environment** or **Secure Agent installation in a local environment** in the Administrator *Runtime Environments* guide.
6. Export assets from your production organization to the pre-release organization for testing. The export process includes connections, but not passwords or security tokens. You'll need to reenter this information in your pre-release organization. You can export up to 1,000 individual assets, folders, and projects.
7. For instructions, see **Asset migration** in the Data Integration *Asset Management* guide, or refer to the Asset Management guide for the service you'll export assets from.
8. Before you run any tasks, update the targets in your imported assets so that you don't accidentally overwrite your target data with test data.

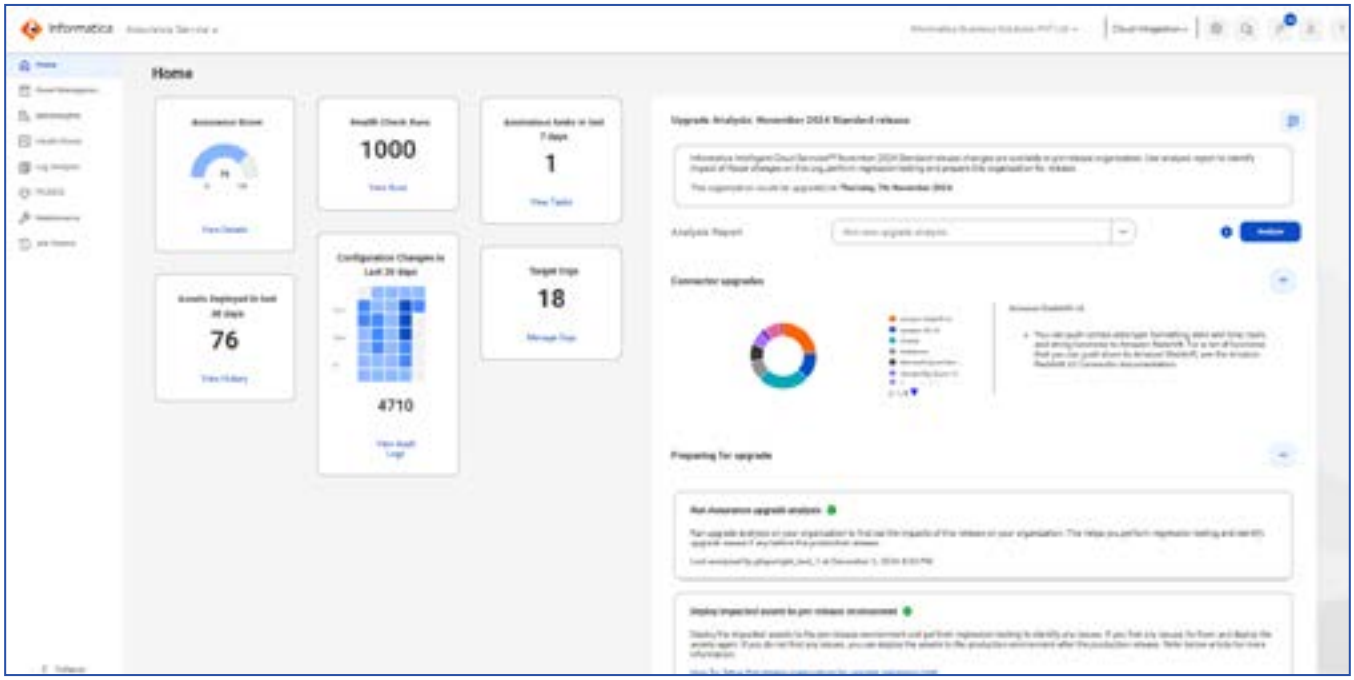
IDMC Assurance Package

You can use the Assurance Package if you use Data Integration and/or Application Integration and your organization is on a supported POD.

For a list of the supported PODs for the Assurance Package, see **POD Availability and Networking**.

The Assurance Package includes the Assurance Service, which is a service you can launch from the **My Services** page. The Assurance Service is a licensed service.

The following image shows the Assurance Service **Home** page:



The Assurance Service helps simplify the upgrade process by helping you understand which assets in your organization will likely be impacted by the features and dependencies in the upcoming release.

If you use Data Integration and/or Application Integration, you can use the Assurance Service “Feature Impact” capability to quickly create a regression suite of tasks to test in your pre-release environment before your production and development environments are upgraded. For more information about this capability, watch the **IDMC Assurance Service Cloud Upgrade Release Impacts** video.

For more information about the Assurance Package, see the **IDMC Assurance Package** data sheet or contact your Informatica Customer Success Manager.

Important Links

The following links contain more information about IDMC releases:

Documentation Portal
Contains product documentation for all services.

IDMC Assurance Package
Provides information about the Assurance Package, which helps you simplify the upgrade process and understand the impact of new functionality on your assets.

To learn more about the "Feature Impact" capability, watch the IDMC Assurance Service Cloud Upgrade Release Impacts video.

POD Availability and Networking
Provides service and network information for each POD. Lists the services that participate in pre-releases.

Pulse
Informatica's service health dashboard that shows the status for all PODs and services across IDMC.

Follow the services you use and subscribe to alerts to get immediate notifications about maintenance, production incidents, and upcoming releases.

To read about Informatica's user communication practices, see Service Status and Communications.

What's New in IDMC
Contains new features, behavior changes, and upgrade information for all services.



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